



Player Report on I. Hughes

Season 2025/2026 Club Wellington Phoenix

Date of Report 20-07-2026 Position LCB / RCB Age 22 Foot Right Height 1.83m

Physique

A well built, physically dominant centre back. Wins the vast majority of his defensive and aerial challenges, a genuine physical presence.

Pace

Not a mobile ball carrier, but positioned to defend rather than to progress play himself.

Work-Rate

Extremely disciplined off the ball. Rarely fouls, rarely caught out of position.

Attitude

Among the most dominant defenders covered in this cycle in one on one and aerial contests. Real physical control of his box.

Technical

A capable, accurate passer who can move the ball forward when needed, without being a specialist distributor.

Intelligence

Reads danger well and times his interventions cleanly rather than relying on recovery pace. An old school stopper with modern passing ability, and he even chips in with the odd goal from set piece situations.

Comments

The most dominant defensive player of the centre backs covered here. Outstanding in duels and in the air, disciplined, and capable enough on the ball not to be a liability in possession. A genuinely strong defensive foundation.

Strengths

- Dominant in duels and in the air
- Very disciplined, low number of fouls
- Reliable passer when asked to move the ball forward
- Occasional goal threat from set pieces

Weaknesses

- Not a ball carrier or progressive runner
- Less involved in duels going forward
- Needs to be paired with more mobile cover alongside him

Overall rating: 7 / 10

Fit pro HK: 6.5 / 10